

DISPARITY, SIX-POINT PROGRAM AND MOVEMENT FOR AUTONOMY



Table 9.1: Some economic indicators

Item	Period	East Bengal	West Pakistan
GNP Growth Rate in Pakistan	1959-1970		5.6%
Five-Year Plan Allocations-Public Sectors (Annual Average)			
1st	1955-1960	38%	62%
2nd	1960-1965	45%	55%
3rd	1965-1970	52%	48%
Private Investment	1963-1964	21%	79%
	1967-1968	22%	78%
Development Expenditure	1955-1960	20%	80%
	1960-1965	35.4%	64.6%
	1965-1970	36%	64%
Export Earnings	1958-1968	59%	41%
Import Expenditures	1958-1968	30%	70%

Table 9.2: Representation in the higher ranks of the central secretariat and the army

Period	Rank	East Bengal	West Pakistan	Total	East Bengal % of Total
CIVIL SERVICE					
1961	Secretary	-	19	19	-
	Joint Secretary	7	39	46	15.22%
1969-70	Secretary	3 (Acting)	17	20	15%
Army					
1965	Major-Generals and above	1 (Maj. Gen.)	16	17	5.88%
1969-70	As Above	1 (As Above)	34	35	2.86%

Sources: Mohammed Ayoob and K. Subrahmanyam, *The Liberation War*; K.B. Sayeed, *Political System of Pakistan* (Boston 1967), p.195; Talukder Maniruzzaman, *The Bangladesh Revolution and its Aftermath*, (Dhaka 1980), p.10.

6-POINT PROGRAMME

- IN 1966, MUJIB PUT FORWARD A 6-POINT PLAN AT A NATIONAL CONFERENCE OF OPPOSITION PARTIES IN LAHORE. THE CITY OF LAHORE WAS CHOSEN BECAUSE OF ITS SYMBOLISM AS THE PLACE WHERE THE LAHORE RESOLUTION WAS ADOPTED BY THE MUSLIM LEAGUE IN 1940.
- THE SIX POINTS CALLED FOR ABOLISHING THE BASIC DEMOCRACY SCHEME, RESTORING UNIVERSAL SUFFRAGE, DEVOLVING FEDERAL POWER TO THE PROVINCES OF EAST AND WEST PAKISTAN, SEPARATE FISCAL, MONETARY AND TRADE POLICIES FOR EAST AND WEST PAKISTAN, AND INCREASED SECURITY SPENDING FOR EAST PAKISTAN.

THE SIX-POINT PROGRAM

- **1) THE CONSTITUTION SHOULD PROVIDE FOR A FEDERATION OF PAKISTAN IN ITS TRUE SENSE BASED ON THE LAHORE RESOLUTION AND THE PARLIAMENTARY FORM OF GOVERNMENT WITH SUPREMACY OF A LEGISLATURE DIRECTLY ELECTED ON THE BASIS OF UNIVERSAL ADULT FRANCHISE.**
- **2) THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT SHOULD DEAL WITH ONLY TWO SUBJECTS: DEFENCE AND FOREIGN AFFAIRS, AND ALL OTHER RESIDUARY SUBJECTS SHALL BE VESTED IN THE FEDERATING STATES.**
- **3) TWO SEPARATE, BUT FREELY CONVERTIBLE CURRENCIES FOR TWO WINGS SHOULD BE INTRODUCED; OR IF THIS IS NOT FEASIBLE, THERE SHOULD BE ONE CURRENCY FOR THE WHOLE COUNTRY, BUT EFFECTIVE CONSTITUTIONAL PROVISIONS SHOULD BE INTRODUCED TO STOP THE FLIGHT OF CAPITAL FROM EAST TO WEST PAKISTAN. FURTHERMORE, A SEPARATE BANKING RESERVE SHOULD BE ESTABLISHED AND A SEPARATE FISCAL AND MONETARY POLICY BE ADOPTED FOR EAST PAKISTAN.**
- **4) THE POWER OF TAXATION AND REVENUE COLLECTION SHALL BE VESTED IN THE FEDERATING UNITS AND THE FEDERAL CENTER WILL HAVE NO SUCH POWER. THE FEDERATION WILL BE ENTITLED TO A SHARE IN THE STATE TAXES TO MEET ITS EXPENDITURES.**
- **5) THERE SHOULD BE TWO SEPARATE ACCOUNTS FOR THE FOREIGN EXCHANGE EARNINGS OF THE TWO WINGS; THE FOREIGN EXCHANGE REQUIREMENTS OF THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT SHOULD BE MET BY THE TWO WINGS EQUALLY OR IN A RATIO TO BE FIXED; INDIGENOUS PRODUCTS SHOULD MOVE FREE OF DUTY BETWEEN THE TWO WINGS, AND THE CONSTITUTION SHOULD EMPOWER THE UNITS TO ESTABLISH TRADE LINKS WITH FOREIGN COUNTRIES.**
- **6) EAST PAKISTAN SHOULD HAVE ITS OWN SECURITY FORCE.**

GEN AYUB'S REACTION TO SIX POINT PROGRAMME

- **GEN AYUB'S REACTION TO THE SIX POINT PROGRAMME WAS TO THREATEN REPRESSION WITH USE OF FORCE. HE LABELLED THE PROGRAMME A SCHEME FOR SECESSION AND DECLARED THAT HE WOULD RESPOND TO IT WITH LANGUAGE OF WEAPON.**
- **THE AWAMI LEAGUE SENSING THE MOOD OF THE BENGALIS DECIDED TO PROPAGATE THE PROGRAMME AMONGST THE PEOPLE. SHEIKH MUJIB AND AWAMI LEAGUE LEADERS TRAVELLED AROUND THE COUNTRY EXPLAINING THE POINT IN DETAIL. THIS INSPIRED A MASS MOVEMENT IN ITS SUPPORT. ON 18 APRIL 1966 SHEIKH MUJIB WAS ARRESTED AND PUT IN DETENTION UNDER THE DEFENCE OF PAKISTAN RULE ON MAY 9. ON 7 JUNE 1966, A SPECIAL PROTEST DAY WAS OBSERVED IN SUPPORT SIX POINT PROGRAMME.**

AGARTALA CONSPIRACY CASE

- **AS THE AUTONOMY MOVEMENT GAINED MOMENTUM PRESIDENT AYUB TOOK ALARM AND TO SILENCE IT PLAYED HIS ANTI INDIA CARD AGAINST THE ARCHITECT OF THE MOVEMENT. IN LATE 1967 HE CHARGED SHEIKH MUJIB AND 28 OTHERS INCLUDING CIVIL AND MILITARY OFFICERS TO CONSPIRE WITH ARCH ENEMY INDIA TO SECEDE PAKISTAN. AYUB KHAN PROMULGATED AN ORDINANCE FOR PUBLIC**
- **TRIAL OF THE TREASON CASE BY A TRIBUNAL: SHEKH MUJIB STRONGLY DENIED THE CHARGE AND TERMED THE AGARTALA CONSPIRACY CASE FALSE, FABRICATED AND INTENDED TO MALIGN AND DEFAME HIM AND HIS PARTY.**
- **IT EVOKED GREAT SYMPATHY FOR SHEIKH MUJIB AMONG THE PEOPLE AS BEING VICTIMIMISED FOR CHAMPIONNIG THEIR CAUSE. HE SOON BECAME UNDISPUTED NATIONAL HERO OF BENGALI.**

PRELUDE TO UPRISING.

- **TOWARDS THE END OF 1968 AN UPRISING AGAINST AYUB KHAN ERUPTED IN WEST PAKISTAN.IT SPREAD TO EAST PAKISTAN WITH MUCH GREATER INTENSITY.MOULANA BHASHANI CALLED FOR HARTAL ON DEC 8 AND DEC 13 WHICH WAS WIDELY OBSERVED IN EAST PAKISTAN.**
- **IN DECEMBER 1968 THE AGITATING NATIONALIST AND PROGRESSIVE STUDENTS OF HIGHR EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS OF EAST PAKISTAN FORMED AN ALL PARTY STUDENT ACTION COMITTEE .THEY CHALKED OUT A COMMON PROGRAMME TO INTENSIFY JOINT MOVEMENT AGAINST AYUB REGIME.SOON THE FORMULATED 11 POINT PROGRAMME OF ACTION.**

11 POINT PROGRAMME OF STUDENTS

11 POINTS

1. CANCELLATION OF ALL ANTI-BENGALI LANGUAGE ACTIONS LIKE THE RECOMMENDATIONS OF THE HAMIDUR RAHMAN EDUCATION COMMITTEE & THE DHAKA UNIVERSITY ORDINANCE (WHICH STRIPPED IT OF ITS AUTONOMY) ALONGSIDE REDUCTION IN MONTHLY TUITION FEES OF THE UNIVERSITY STUDENTS.
2. RESTORATION OF PARLIAMENTARY DEMOCRACY BASED ON UNIVERSAL ADULT FRANCHISE, FREEDOM OF THE PRESS & UPLIFTING THE BAN ON THE DAILY ITTEFAQ
3. COMPLETE AUTONOMY FOR EAST PAKISTAN BASED ON THE PREVIOUS 6-POINTS.
4. FORMATION OF A FEDERAL GOVERNMENT IN WEST PAKISTAN CONSISTING OF THE AUTONOMOUS PROVINCES OF PUNJAB, SINDH, KHYBER PAKHTUNKHWA & BALUCHISTAN (WHICH HAD BEEN DISSOLVED BY THE AYUB KHAN GOVERNMENT UNDER THE ONE UNIT SCHEME)
5. NATIONALISATION OF BANKS, INSURANCE COMPANIES & ALL LARGE INDUSTRIES, INCLUDING JUTE PROCESSING UNITS.

11 POINT PROGRAMME OF STUDENTS

- **6. DECREASED TAXATION UPON THE FARMERS & SETTING THE MINIMUM PRICE OF RAW JUTE AT 40 RUPEES.**
- **7. PROVIDING RESPECTABLE WAGES, EDUCATION, TREATMENT & RESIDENCE TO THE WORKERS ALONGSIDE RECOGNITION TO THEIR RIGHT TO STRIKE.**
- **8. TAKING ADEQUATE STEPS TO CONTROL FLOODS & UTILISING THE WATER RESOURCES OF EAST PAKISTAN.**
- **9. ABROGATION OF ALL DRACONIAN LAWS ENACTED BY THE MILITARY REGIME OF AYUB KHAN.**
- **10. PAKISTAN'S EXIT FROM SEATO & CENTO ALONGSIDE FORMULATION OF A NEUTRAL FOREIGN POLICY**
- **11. ABROGATION OF WARRANTS AGAINST THOSE ACCUSED OF PARTICIPATING IN THE AGARTALA CONSPIRACY CASE ALONGSIDE RELEASE OF ALL STUDENTS, FARMERS, WORKERS & POLITICAL ACTIVISTS IMPRISONED THROUGHOUT THE COUNTRY CONVICTED UNDER IT.**

SHEIKH MUJIB DECLARED BANGABANDHU

- **ON HIS RELEASE SHIKH MUJIB WAS GIVEN ROUSING RECEPTION BY ALL PARTY STUDENT ACTION COMMITTEE IN PALTAN.THE THE DUCSU VP TOFAIL AHMED DECLARED HIM THE BANGA BANDU FRIEND OF BENGAL. AS HE HE HAD BECOME THE MOVING FORCE UPRING AGAIST AYUB.HE ALSO CAME OUT AS UNDISPUTED LEADER OF BANGALI.**

UPRISING OF 1969

- **STUDENT ACTION COMMITTEE AND POLITICAL PARTIES COMBINED INTENSIFIED THE MOVEMENT WITH OVERWHELMING PARTICIPATION OF MASS PEOPLE..IN THE MOVEMENT USE OF BRUTAL LD TO THE MYRTERDOOM OF ASAD, MATIUR AND SHASUZZOHA IN RAJSHAHI. THE MOVEMENT REACHED ITS PEAK.IT WAS UNPRECEDENTED POLITICAL IN BOTH WINGS OF THE COUNTRY.**
- **AYUB UNABLE TO CONTAIN THE MOVEMENT OF SUCH A GREATER INTENSITY INVITED LEADER OF THE OPPOSITION PARTY TO A ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE FOR POLITICAL SOLUTION.SHEIK MUJIB WAS RELEASED AND THE TREASON CASE BROUGHT AGAINST HIM WAS DECLARED CONSTITUTIONALLY INVALID.**
- **ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE FAILED ,BUT AYUB TO TRIED TO CLING TO POWER THROUGH DECLARATION OF MARTIAL LAW BUT AT THE PEAK OF UPRISING IN BOTH WING OF PAKISTAN AYUB BOWED DOWN .ON 25 MARCH 1969 HE HANDED OVER POWE TO GENERAL YAHIA KHAN AS COMMANDER IN CHIEF OF ARMED FORCES.**